

down laptops as soon as they connect to the Internet. The software operates in stealth mode, sending information that will be helpful to police, ISPs and security agencies in tracking down the location from where the laptop was used.

9.1.2. System-level Deterrents

- Use a strong BIOS password—one that is hard to guess and is not a standard dictionary term. Some laptops offer the facility of locking the hard disk as well with the BIOS password. This way, even if the thief removes the hard disk and tries to use it on another machine, it will not be accessible.
- Use a modern OS such as Windows 2000 Professional or Windows XP Professional. (Linux, too, though we do not cover it here).
- Configure your Windows system to always require a password to log in. (Go to **Control Panel > User Accounts**, and ensure that “Users must enter a user name and password is password” is checked.)
- Enable strong passwords. Go to **Control Panel > Administrative Tools > Local Security Policy**. In Password Policy (under Account Policies), change the value of the setting “Passwords must meet minimum complexity requirements” to Enabled. Passwords henceforth will be required to meet the following minimum characteristics:
 - Should not contain significant portions of the username or full name
 - Should be at least six characters long
 - Should contain characters from at least three of the following four categories:
 - English uppercase (A to Z)
 - English lowercase (a to z)